
pyTempico

Release 2.0.3

Tausand Electronics

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PyTempico is a Python library developed by Tausand Electronics, with Joan Amaya and David Guzman as the lead developers. It enables seamless interaction with Tempico, Tausand's Time-to-Digital Converter devices, facilitating data communication and control. The library relies on key modules such as hid and pyserial for efficient device connectivity. For more information, visit tausand.com

Release 2.0.3

PYTEMPICO PACKAGE

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Core class and methods for PyTempico library.

To use with Tausand Electronics' Time-to-Digital Converters (TDCs) of the family *Tausand Tempico*.

1.1 TempicoDevicesSearch class

class `pyTempico.core.TempicoDevicesSearch`

A class for discovering Tempico devices.

This class provides methods to search for Tempico devices in a network or connected system.

findDevices()

Finds and verifies whether a device with the given VID and PID is a Tempico device.

This function takes the Vendor ID (VID) and Product ID (PID) as inputs, converts them to integers, and attempts to open the device using these values. It then checks if the manufacturer and product strings match the expected values for a Tempico device.

Parameters

- **vid_s** (*str*) – The Vendor ID (VID) of the device in string format.
- **pid_s** (*str*) – The Product ID (PID) of the device in string format.

Returns *True* if the device is a Tempico, *False* otherwise.

Return type `bool`

getVidPid(vid_pid_information)

Extracts the Vendor ID (VID) and Product ID (PID) from a string and returns them as a tuple.

This function processes a string that contains the VID and PID information in the format 'VID:PID=xxxx:yyyy'. It splits the string and retrieves the VID and PID values, returning them as a tuple of strings.

Parameters **vid_pid_information** (*str*) – A string containing the VID and PID information.

Returns A tuple containing the VID and PID as strings (vid, pid).

Return type tuple

tryOpenDevices(vid_s, pid_s)

Finds and verifies whether a device with the given VID and PID is a Tempico device.

This function takes the Vendor ID (VID) and Product ID (PID) as inputs, converts them to integers, and attempts to open the device using these values. It then checks if the manufacturer and product strings match the expected values for a Tempico device.

Parameters

- **vid_s** (str) – The Vendor ID (VID) of the device in string format.
- **pid_s** (str) – The Product ID (PID) of the device in string format.

Returns *True* if the device is a Tempico, *False* otherwise.

Return type bool

verifyPyTempico(tuple_vid_pid)

Verifies whether the connected device is a Tempico device.

This function checks if the device's Vendor ID (VID) and Product ID (PID) match the values corresponding to a Tempico device. It returns *True* if the device is identified as a Tempico, and *False* otherwise.

Parameters **tuple_vid_pid** (tuple) – A tuple containing the VID and PID of the device.

Returns *True* if the device is a Tempico, *False* otherwise.

Return type bool

1.2 TempicoDevice class

class pyTempico.core.TempicoDevice(com_port)

Tausand Tempico TDC device object.

To create an object of the [TempicoDevice\(\)](#) class, it is required to send as parameter the desired com_port. For example,

```
>>> my_tempico_device_object = pyTempico.TempicoDevice('COM5')
```

To modify or access attributes, **please use methods**. For example,

```
>>> my_tempico_device_object.getIdn()
```

To access attributes of a particular channel, use methods of the [TempicoChannel\(\)](#) class through attributes ch1, ch2, ch3, ch4 of this class. For example, to get average cycles on channel 2,

```
>>> my_tempico_device_object.ch2.getAverageCycles()
```

or, as an alternative, send the channel number as a parameter

```
>>> my_tempico_device_object.getAverageCycles(2)
```

Changing attributes without using methods, do not change the actual parameters in the device.

Accessing attributes without using methods, returns values registered in local memory, that may not be updated.

To begin a measurement and read its results, use methods [measure\(\)](#) and [fetch\(\)](#).

id_tempico_device

Unique identifier of the *TempicoDevice()* object.

Type int

ch1

Object of the *TempicoChannel()* class linked to TDC in channel 1 (input A).

Type *TempicoChannel*

ch2

Object of the *TempicoChannel()* class linked to TDC in channel 2 (input B).

Type *TempicoChannel*

ch3

Object of the *TempicoChannel()* class linked to TDC in channel 3 (input C).

Type *TempicoChannel*

ch4

Object of the *TempicoChannel()* class linked to TDC in channel 4 (input D).

Type *TempicoChannel*

device

Serial port object.

Type Serial

idn

Identification string.

Type str

number_of_channels

number of stop inputs of the device.

Type int

number_of_runs

Number of measurement runs of the TDCs in *TempicoDevice()*.

Type int

port

Serial port string.

Type str

threshold

Threshold voltage on the rising edge of start and stops inputs of TDCs in the *TempicoDevice()*.

Type float

abort(validate=True)

Cancels an ongoing measurement on the *TempicoDevice()*.

This function sends a cancel command to the *TempicoDevice()* to stop any measurement currently in progress. It ensures that all measurement processes are halted and the device is ready for a new operation or safely turned off.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*.

Parameters **validate** (*bool*, *optional*) – If True, waits and validates if every channel applies the abort successfully. Default is True.

calibrateDelay()

Calibrates the internal delay.

This command adjusts the hardware's internal timing delay to ensure accurate measurements. Only supported on devices with hardware version "TP12".

Parameters **None** –

Returns **None**

cleanNumberList(*number_list*)

Removes non-valid elements of a Tempico dataset, given in *number_list*, a number 2D-list (read data). Returns a clean number 2D-list.

Validations applied:

- length of row
- type of data (integers, except for start_s register)
- ch in range
- run in range
- sorted stops
- stops in range
- sequential run values
- increasing start

The dataset of a *TempicoDevice()* is in the following format:

`[[ch,run,start_s,stop_ps1,...,stop_psN],...,[ch,run,start_time_us,stop_ps1,...,stop_psN]]`

where

- 'ch' indicates the TDC channel,
- 'run' goes from 1 to NumberOfRuns,
- 'start_s' is the epoch timestamp of start pulse, in seconds, with microseconds precision; this value overflows (go back to zero) after 2^{32} seconds,
- 'stop_ps1' is the measured precision timelapse between start and the 1st stop pulse, in picoseconds,
- 'N' is the NumberOfStops.

Parameters **number_list** (*list(number)*) – a complete dataset message converted.

Returns a cleaned complete dataset message converted.

Return type `list(number)`

close()

Ends (closes) a connection with a *TempicoDevice()*.

It is recommended to close connection at the end of a routine, to free the device's port for future use.

Parameters (**none**) –

closeTempico()

Ends (closes) a connection with a *TempicoDevice()*.

Same as method *close()*.

Parameters (**none**) –

convertReadDataToFloatList(*data_string*)

Converts a string with a read dataset message issued by a *TempicoDevice()*, into an float 2D-list.

The dataset of a *TempicoDevice()* is in the following format:

```
[[ch,run,start_s,stop_ps1,...,stop_psN],...,[ch,run,start_time_us,stop_ps1,...,stop_psN]]
```

where

- 'ch' indicates the TDC channel,
- 'run' goes from 1 to NumberOfRuns,
- 'start_s' is the epoch timestamp of start pulse, in seconds, with microseconds precision; this value overflows (go back to zero) after 2^{32} seconds,
- 'stop_ps1' is the measured precision timelapse between start and the 1st stop pulse, in picoseconds,
- 'N' is the NumberOfStops.

Every value in the dataset is converted to a float.

Parameters *data_string* (*str*) – dataset message to convert.

Returns dataset message converted.

Return type list(float)

convertReadDataToNumberList(*data_string*)

Converts a string with a read dataset message issued by a *TempicoDevice()*, into a number 2D-list (integer or float).

The dataset of a *TempicoDevice()* is in the following format:

```
[[ch,run,start_s,stop_ps1,...,stop_psN],...,[ch,run,start_time_us,stop_ps1,...,stop_psN]]
```

where

- 'ch' (int) indicates the TDC channel,
- 'run' (int) goes from 1 to NumberOfRuns,
- 'start_s' (float) is the epoch timestamp of start pulse, in seconds, with microseconds precision; this value overflows (go back to zero) after 2^{32} seconds,
- 'stop_ps1' (int) is the measured precision timelapse between start and the 1st stop pulse, in picoseconds,
- 'N' (int) is the NumberOfStops.

Every value in the dataset is either an integer or a float.

Parameters *data_string* (*str*) – dataset message to convert.

Returns dataset message converted.

Return type list(number)

decrementGeneratorFrequency()

Decreases the internal generator frequency by one step (only for TP12 devices).

This function reduces the generator frequency on a predefined decrement scale, $\{1, 2, 5\} \cdot 10^n$, depending on the current frequency.

Parameters *None* –

Returns *None*

decrementThresholdVoltage()

Reduces the threshold voltage on the rising edge of start and stops inputs of TDCs in the *TempicoDevice()*.

To validate the actual threshold voltage applied, method *getThresholdVoltage()* should be called.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*.

Parameters (none) –

disableChannel(channel)

Disables the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, channels are enabled.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, and delegates the disabling operation to the selected *TempicoChannel()*. If the channel is invalid, the function does nothing.

To validate the status of the channel, method *isEnabled()* may be used.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access and configure the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters channel (int or str) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

enableChannel(channel)

Enables the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, channels are enabled.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, and delegates the enabling operation to the selected *TempicoChannel()*. If the channel is invalid, the function does nothing.

To validate the status of the channel, method *isEnabled()* may be used.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access and configure the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters channel (int or str) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

fetch(validate=True)

Reads the most recent measurement data set form a *TempicoDevice()*.

The dataset of a *TempicoDevice()* is in the following format:

```
[ [ch,run,start_s,stop_ps1,...,stop_psN], ..., [ch,run,start_time_us,stop_ps1,...,  
↪ stop_psN] ]
```

where

- 'ch' (int) indicates the TDC channel,
- 'run' (int) goes from 1 to NumberOfRuns,

- 'start_s' (float) is the epoch timestamp of start pulse, in seconds with microsecond resolution. This value overflows (go back to zero) after 2^{32} seconds,
- 'stop_ps1' (int) is the measured precision timelapse between start and the 1st stop pulse, in picoseconds,
- 'N' (int) is the NumberOfStops.

Every value in the dataset is either an integer or a float number.

If no measurement has been done, the device may respond with an empty dataset. To make a new measurement, method `measure()` must be used.

This function requires that a connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`.

Parameters `validate` (*bool, optional*) – If True, the measured dataset is validated, and invalid registers get cleaned. Default is True.

Returns measured dataset.

Return type list(number)

getAverageCycles(*channel*)

Returns the average cycles of the specified `TempicoChannel()`.

By default, average cycles = 1 (no multi-cycle averaging).

If the connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`, this function delegates the query to the selected channel object and retrieves its average cycles value. If the connection is not open, or the channel is invalid, the function returns -1.

This version belongs to the `TempicoDevice()` class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'-'D') to access the corresponding `TempicoChannel()`.

Parameters `channel` (*int or str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

Returns Number of average cycles, or -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type integer

getBaudRate()

Returns the `TempicoDevice()` baud rate.

Parameters (*none*) –

Returns baud rate.

Return type int

getDateTime(*convert_to_datetime=False*)

Same as `getDatetime`

getDatetime(*convert_to_datetime=False*)

Returns the number of seconds since the Tempico device was powered on, based on its internal clock. If the device has been synchronized, the seconds count corresponds to the system time of the host PC.

This function sends the `DTIME?` command to the device, reads the response, and parses it into a float representing the elapsed time in seconds. If the device does not respond correctly, the function returns -1.

The timestamp resolution is in microseconds (μ s), and the count starts from power-up by default. Synchronization with the PC time must be previously configured on the device, otherwise the value is relative to the device's uptime.

Parameters `convert_to_datetime` (*bool, optional*) – If True, the value is returned as a datetime object. Default is False.

Returns Elapsed time in seconds since the device was powered on or synchronized with the PC clock. Returns -1 if no valid response is received.

Return type float

getDelay(*channel*)

Retrieves the internal delay for the specified channel, in picoseconds.

In TP10 devices, this value is zero. In TP12 devices, this value is read from the device.

The function selects the given channel and queries its current delay setting. If the channel is invalid, it returns -1.

Parameters `channel` (*int*) – channel number to read the delay from.

Returns internal delay of the stop channel with respect to the start, in picoseconds. Returns -1 when fails.

Return type float

getFirmware()

Returns the `TempicoDevice()` firmware version.

Parameters (*none*) –

Returns firmware version.

Return type str

getGeneratorFrequency()

Returns the frequency of the internal pulse generator (only for TP12 devices).

This function queries the device with the 'CONF:GEN:FREQ?' command to obtain the current frequency of the internal pulse generator. If the connection is not open, an informational message is printed. This feature is not available on TP1004 devices.

Parameters *None* –

Returns Current frequency of the internal pulse generator. Returns an empty string if it cannot be retrieved.

Return type float

getIdn()

Returns the `TempicoDevice()` identification string.

If the connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`, this function request the device for the string. If not, the most recent read string is returned.

Parameters (*none*) –

Returns identification string.

Return type str

getLastDelaySync(*convert_to_datetime=False*)

Returns the timestamp of the last delay calibration performed on the `TempicoDevice()`.

If the device is connected and the hardware version is “TP12”, the function requests the last delay calibration time using the ‘DTIME:LDElay?’ command. If *convert_to_datetime* is True, the value is returned as a datetime object.

Parameters *convert_to_datetime* (*bool*, *optional*) – If True, returns the timestamp as a datetime object. Default is False.

Returns Timestamp of the last delay calibration, as a Unix timestamp or datetime object. Returns -1 if it cannot be retrieved.

Return type float or datetime

getLastStart(*convert_to_datetime=False*)

Returns the datetime of the last start event registered by the *TempicoDevice()*.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function requests the device for the last start timestamp using the ‘DTIME:LStart?’ command. If not, the value -1 is returned.

The returned value corresponds to the timestamp of the most recent start event. If no start has occurred yet, the device returns 0. If *convert_to_datetime* is set to True, the value is returned as a datetime object instead of a float.

Parameters *convert_to_datetime* (*bool*, *optional*) – If True, the value is returned as a datetime object. Default is False.

Returns Timestamp of the last start event, either as a float (Unix timestamp) or as a datetime object if *convert_to_datetime* is True. Returns -1 if the value could not be retrieved.

Return type float or datetime

getLastSync(*convert_to_datetime=False*)

Returns the datetime of the last synchronization performed on the *TempicoDevice()*.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function requests the device for the last synchronization timestamp using the ‘DTIME:LSYNc?’ command. If not, the value -1 is returned.

The returned value corresponds to the timestamp of the most recent synchronization with the host system. If no synchronization has occurred yet, the device returns 0. If *convert_to_datetime* is set to True, the value is returned as a datetime object instead of a float.

Parameters *convert_to_datetime* (*bool*, *optional*) – If True, the value is returned as a datetime object. Default is False.

Returns Timestamp of the last synchronization event, either as a float (Unix timestamp) or as a datetime object if *convert_to_datetime* is True. Returns -1 if the value could not be retrieved.

Return type float or datetime

getMaximumDateTime(*convert_to_datetime=False*)

Same as getMaximumDatetime

getMaximumDatetime(*convert_to_datetime=False*)

Returns the maximum datetime value allowed by the *TempicoDevice()*.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function requests the device for the maximum allowed date using the ‘DTIME:MAXimum?’ command. If not, the value -1 is returned.

The returned value corresponds to the latest timestamp that can be set on the device without causing an error. If *convert_to_datetime* is set to True, the value is returned as a datetime object instead of a float.

Parameters *convert_to_datetime* (*bool*, *optional*) – If True, the value is returned as a datetime object. Default is False.

Returns Maximum allowed datetime, either as a float (Unix timestamp) or as a datetime object if `convert_to_datetime` is `True`.

Return type float or datetime

getMinimumDateTime(*convert_to_datetime=False*)

Same as `getMinimumDatetime`

getMinimumDatetime(*convert_to_datetime=False*)

Returns the minimum datetime value allowed by the `TempicoDevice()`.

If the connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`, this function requests the device for the minimum allowed date using the 'DTIME:MINimum?' command. If not, the value -1 is returned.

The returned value corresponds to the earliest timestamp that can be set on the device without causing an error. If `convert_to_datetime` is set to `True`, the value is returned as a datetime object instead of a float.

Parameters `convert_to_datetime` (*bool, optional*) – If `True`, the value is returned as a datetime object. Default is `False`.

Returns Minimum allowed datetime, either as a float (Unix timestamp) or as a datetime object if `convert_to_datetime` is `True`.

Return type float or datetime

getMode(*channel*)

Returns the measurement mode of the specified `TempicoChannel()`.

By default, mode = 1.

If the connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`, this function delegates the query to the selected channel object and retrieves its current measurement mode. If the connection is not open, or the channel is invalid, the function returns -1.

This version belongs to the `TempicoDevice()` class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'-'D') to access the corresponding `TempicoChannel()`.

Parameters `channel` (*int or str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

Returns

Mode. Possible values are:

In TP1004:

- 1: Short measurement range. Start-stop times from 12ns to 500ns.
- 2: Large measurement range. Start-stop times from 125ns to 4ms.

In TP1204:

- 1: Short measurement range. Start-stop times from -200ns to 300ns.
- 2: Large measurement range. Start-stop times from -50ns to 4ms.

Returns -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type integer

getModelIdn()

Returns the identifier of the model associated with the device.

Returns The internal model identifier (*model_idn*).

Return type str

getNumberOfRuns()

Returns the number of measurement runs of the TDCs in *TempicoDevice()*.

By default, number of runs = 1 (single measurement).

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function request the device for the value. If not, the most recent value is returned.

Parameters (none) –

Returns Number of number of runs.

Return type integer

getNumberOfStops(channel)

Returns the expected number of stop pulses for the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, number of stops = 1 (single start → single stop).

The TDC must receive all the expected number of stops to register them as a valid measurement; otherwise, the measurements are discarded.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function delegates the query to the selected channel object and retrieves its number of stops. If the connection is not open, or the channel is invalid, the function returns -1.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters channel (*int* or *str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

Returns Number of stops, or -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type integer

getOverflowParameter()

Retrieves the overflow parameter.

The returned value depends on the device hardware version. For TP12 devices, the function returns -1000000; otherwise, it returns -1.

Parameters None –

Returns Overflow parameter value based on the hardware version.

Return type int

getSerialNumber()

Returns the serial number of the connected *TempicoDevice()*.

This function searches for the serial number associated with the current COM port used by the device. If the connection is established, it queries the list of available serial ports to match the active one and extract its serial number.

If the connection is not open, a message is printed and an empty string is returned.

Parameters (none) –

Returns Serial number of the device, or empty string if not found or if the connection is not open.
e.g: “TP1004-220500”

Return type string

getSettings()

Reads the current settings form a *TempicoDevice()*.

The response for settings query on a *TempicoDevice()* is in the following format:

```
CH1:ACYC 1;CH1:ENAB 1;CH1:NST 1;...;CH4:STOP:MASK 0.0000;NRUN 1;THR 1.00
```

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*.

Parameters (none) –

Returns device settings.

Return type str

getStartEdge(channel)

Returns the edge type used on start pulses of the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, start edge = ‘RISE’.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function delegates the query to the selected channel object and retrieves its configured start edge type. If the connection is not open, or the channel is invalid, the function returns -1.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label (‘A’–‘D’) to access the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters channel (int or str) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or ‘A’ or ‘a’
- 2 or ‘B’ or ‘b’
- 3 or ‘C’ or ‘c’
- 4 or ‘D’ or ‘d’

Returns

Start edge type. Possible values are:

- ‘RISE’: TDC timing starts on a rising edge of the start pulse.
- ‘FALL’: TDC timing starts on a falling edge of the start pulse.

Returns -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type string or int

getStartSource(channel)

Returns the start signal source for the specified channel.

This function checks whether the start signal of the selected channel comes from the internal generator or from an external input connected to the device.

Parameters `channel` (*int*) – Channel number to read the start source from.

Returns Start source identifier. Returns -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type `int`

getState(*channel*)

Returns the state of the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

This function is used to validate if a reset or an abort command has been successfully applied.

Some possible states are:

- 0: disabled.
- 1: idle, enabled.
- 10: processing a reset.
- 11: processing an abort.

other states are related with the measurement process.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters `channel` (*int* or *str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

Returns

state.

Returns -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type `int`

getStates()

Returns a list with the state of each *TempicoChannel()* within *TempicoDevice()*.

This function is used to validate if a reset or an abort command has been successfully applied.

Some possible states are:

- 0: disabled.
- 1: idle, enabled.
- 10: processing a reset.
- 11: processing an abort.

other states are related with the measurement process.

Parameters (*none*) –

Returns states per channel.

Return type `list(integer)`

getStatus(channel)

Returns the internal status of the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

This function is used to obtain the state of a channel, used to validate if a reset or an abort command has been successfully applied.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters **channel** (*int* or *str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

Returns

status fields and values.

Returns -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type dict

getStopEdge(channel)

Returns the edge type used on stop pulses of the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, stop edge = 'RISE'.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function delegates the query to the selected channel object and retrieves its configured stop edge type. If the connection is not open, or the channel is invalid, the function returns -1.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters **channel** (*int* or *str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

Returns

Stop edge type. Possible values are:

- 'RISE': TDC timing ends on a rising edge of the stop pulse.
- 'FALL': TDC timing ends on a falling edge of the stop pulse.

Returns -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type string or int

getStopMask(channel)

Returns the stop mask time (in microseconds) of the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, in TP1004 stop mask = 0us (no masking). By default, in TP1204 stop mask = -0.25us (no masking).

The stop mask defines the period after receiving a start pulse during which stop pulses are ignored. This helps eliminate unwanted noise or early pulses.

If the connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`, this function delegates the query to the selected channel object and retrieves its current stop mask time. If the connection is not open, or the channel is invalid, the function returns -1.

This version belongs to the `TempicoDevice()` class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access the corresponding `TempicoChannel()`.

Parameters `channel` (*int* or *str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

Returns Stop mask time in microseconds, or -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type float

`getStopMaskMinimum()`

Retrieves the minimum stop mask value, in microseconds.

The returned value depends on the device hardware version. For TP12 devices, the function returns -0.25; otherwise, it returns 0.

Parameters `None` –

Returns minimum stop mask value based on the hardware version.

Return type float

`getStopSource(channel)`

Returns the stop signal source for the specified channel.

This function checks whether the stop signal of the selected channel comes from the internal generator or from an external input connected to the device.

Parameters `channel` (*int*) – Channel number to read the stop source from.

Returns Stop source identifier. Returns -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type int

`getTempicoChannel(channel)`

Returns the `TempicoChannel()` object corresponding to the specified channel.

This function allows selecting a channel by its number (1–4) or label ('A'–'D'). If the input is valid, it returns the corresponding `TempicoChannel()` instance. If the input is invalid, an error message is printed and -1 is returned.

Parameters `channel` (*int* or *str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

Returns The corresponding `TempicoChannel()` object if the input is valid, or -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type *TempicoChannel* or int

getThresholdVoltage()

Returns the threshold voltage on the rising edge of start and stops inputs of TDCs in the *TempicoDevice()*.

Start and stop inputs are coupled to 50 ohms.

By default, threshold voltage = 1.00V (recommended for TTL>2.5V).

All inputs are 5V tolerant.

Gate input. This parameter does not have effect on the gate input. Gate input accepts 3.3V TTL and 5V TTL signals.

- When gate is disconnected, system is enabled.
- When gate is connected to 0V, system is disabled.
- When gate is connected to 3.3V/5V, system is enabled.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function request the device for the value. If not, the most recent value is returned.

Parameters (none) –

Returns start and stop inputs threshold voltage.

Return type float

incrementGeneratorFrequency()

Increases the internal generator frequency by one step (only for TP12 devices).

This function raises the generator frequency on a predefined increment scale, $\{1, 2, 5\} \cdot 10^n$, depending on the current frequency.

Parameters None –

Returns None

incrementThresholdVoltage()

Increases the threshold voltage on the rising edge of start and stops inputs of TDCs in the *TempicoDevice()*.

To validate the actual threshold voltage applied, method *getThresholdVoltage()* should be called.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*.

Parameters (none) –

isEnabled(channel)

Returns whether the specified *TempicoChannel()* is enabled.

By default, channels are enabled.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function delegates the query to the selected channel object and retrieves its current enable status. If the connection is not open, or the channel is invalid, the function returns -1.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'-'D') to access and query the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters channel (int or str) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:

- 1 or 'A' or 'a'
- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'

- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

Returns True if the channel is enabled, False if disabled, or -1 if the channel is invalid.

Return type bool or int

isIdle()

Finds if every channel in the *TempicoDevice()* is in the idle state.

This method is used to validate if a reset command has been successfully applied.

Returns True if every channel is idle.

Return type bool

isIdleOrDisabled()

Finds if every channel in the *TempicoDevice()* is in the idle state or in the disabled state.

This method is used to validate if an abort command has been successfully applied.

Returns True if every channel is either idle or disabled.

Return type bool

isOpen()

Returns if a TDC *TempicoDevice()* connection is established (open).

Parameters (none) –

Returns True when *TempicoDevice()* connection is open.

Return type bool

isPendingReadMessage()

Determines if a pending message is available to be read in a *TempicoDevice()* serial port.

Parameters (none) –

Returns True, when a pending message is found.

Return type bool

isValidConsecutiveNumberListRows(row, next_row)

Pair of consecutive rows validation of a number 2D-list (read data).

Validations applied:

- length of next_row
- sequential run values
- increasing start

A single row of the dataset of a *TempicoDevice()* is in the following format:

[ch,run,start_s,stop_ps1,...,stop_psN]

where

- 'ch' indicates the TDC channel,
- 'run' goes from 1 to NumberOfRuns,
- 'start_s' is the epoch timestamp of start pulse, in seconds, with microseconds precision; this value overflows (go back to zero) after 2^{32} seconds,
- 'stop_ps1' is the measured precision timelapse between start and the 1st stop pulse, in picoseconds,
- 'N' is the NumberOfStops.

Parameters

- **row** (*list(number)*) – single line of dataset message converted.
- **next_row** (*list(number)*) – next single line of dataset message converted.

Returns True when pair of rows passes all validations.

Return type bool

isValidNumberListRow(*row*)

Single row validation of a number 2D-list (read data).

Validations applied:

- length of row
- type of data (integers, except for start_s register)
- ch in range
- run in range
- sorted stops
- stops in range

A single row of the dataset of a *TempicoDevice()* is in the following format:

[ch,run,start_s,stop_ps1,...,stop_psN]

where

- ‘ch’ indicates the TDC channel,
- ‘run’ goes from 1 to NumberOfRuns,
- ‘start_s’ is the epoch timestamp of start pulse, in seconds, with microseconds precision; this value overflows (go back to zero) after 2³² seconds,
- ‘stop_ps1’ is the measured precision timelapse between start and the 1st stop pulse, in picoseconds,
- ‘N’ is the NumberOfStops.

Parameters **row** (*list(number)*) – single line of dataset message converted.

Returns True when single row passes all validations.

Return type bool

measure(*validate=True*)

Begins a measurement sequence and reads its dataset from a *TempicoDevice()*.

The dataset of a *TempicoDevice()* is in the following format:

```
[[ch,run,start_s,stop_ps1,...,stop_psN],..., [ch,run,start_time_us,stop_ps1,...,  
↪stop_psN]]
```

where

- ‘ch’ (int) indicates the TDC channel,
- ‘run’ (int) goes from 1 to NumberOfRuns,
- ‘start_s’ (float) is the epoch timestamp of start pulse, in seconds with microsecond resolution. This value overflows (go back to zero) after 2³² seconds,

- ‘stop_ps1’ (int) is the measured precision timelapse between start and the 1st stop pulse, in picoseconds,
- ‘N’ (int) is the NumberOfStops.

Every value in the dataset is either an integer or a float number.

If measurement cannot be completed within timeout, the device may respond with an incomplete or empty dataset. In this case, to obtain a complete dataset, the method `fetch()` may be called later.

This function requires that a connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`.

Parameters `validate` (*bool*, *optional*) – If True, the measured dataset is validated, and invalid registers get cleaned. Default is True.

Returns measured dataset.

Return type list(number)

`open()`

Establishes (opens) a connection with a `TempicoDevice()`.

It is mandatory to establish a connection with this method before to be able to send/to receive data to/from the device.

Parameters (*none*) –

`openTempico()`

Establishes (opens) a connection with a `TempicoDevice()`.

Same as method `open()`.

Parameters (*none*) –

`readIdnFromDevice()`

Returns the `TempicoDevice()` identification string, by requesting it to the device.

This function requires that a connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`. As an alternative, method `getIdn()` may be used.

Parameters (*none*) –

Returns identification string.

Return type str

`readMessage()`

Reads pending messages sent by a `TempicoDevice()` from its serial port.

If no message is received, it waits the port timeout, typically 1s.

This function requires that a connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`.

Parameters (*none*) –

Returns read message.

Return type str

`reset(validate=True)`

Sends a reset command to the `TempicoDevice()`.

Applying a reset clears all the settings of the `TempicoDevice()` and its TempicoChannels to their default values.

This function requires that a connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`.

Parameters `validate` (*bool, optional*) – If True, waits and validates if every channel applies the reset successfully. Default is True.

selfTest()

Performs a self-test on the `TempicoDevice()` hardware.

This function initiates a self-diagnostic test on the `TempicoDevice()` to verify its hardware integrity. If the self-test is successful, it prints the message “Self test passed. Device is working properly.” If the self-test fails, it prints the message “Self test failed. Device may have a problem.”, indicating a potential issue with the hardware that may require further investigation or support.

This function requires that a connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`.

Parameters (*none*) –

Returns None

setAverageCycles(channel, averageCycles)

Modifies the average cycles of the specified `TempicoChannel()`.

By default, average cycles = 1 (no multi-cycle averaging).

This function requires that a connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()`, and delegates the configuration to the selected `TempicoChannel()`. If the channel is invalid, the function does nothing.

This version belongs to the `TempicoDevice()` class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access and configure the corresponding `TempicoChannel()`.

Parameters

- **channel** (*int or str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:
 - 1 or 'A' or 'a'
 - 2 or 'B' or 'b'
 - 3 or 'C' or 'c'
 - 4 or 'D' or 'd'
- **averageCycles** (*int*) – Desired average cycles for the TDC. Valid values are: 1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32, 64, 128.

setDateTime(timestampDateTime=None)

Same as setDatetime

setDatetime(timestampDateTime=None)

Sets the internal clock of the Tempico device to a specified timestamp or to the current system time.

Sends a `DTIME <timestamp>` command using either the provided `timestampDateTime` or the current time in Unix format with microsecond precision. If no response is received from the device, the function verifies the update by comparing timestamps.

Parameters `timestampDateTime` (*float, optional*) – Unix timestamp (in seconds) to set on the device. If not provided, the current system time is used.

Returns None

setGeneratorFrequency(desired_frequency)

Sets the frequency of the internal pulse generator (only for TP12 devices).

This function changes the frequency of the internal generator using the 'CONF:GEN:FREQ' command. The value must be between 10 Hz and 10 000 000 Hz. The command is verified by reading back the applied frequency and checking that the relative error is below 0.5%. If the connection is not open or the hardware version is not supported, an informational message is printed.

Parameters `desired_frequency` (*float*) – Desired generator frequency in hertz (10 Hz – 10 000 000 Hz).

Returns None

setMaximumDateTime(*maximum_datetime*)

Same as setMaximumDatetime

setMaximumDatetime(*maximum_datetime*)

Sets the maximum datetime value allowed by the *TempicoDevice()*.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function sends the 'DTIME:MAXimum <timestamp>' command to update the maximum allowed timestamp. If the device accepts the value, it should return a confirmation response. If no response is received, the value is validated by re-reading it from the device.

Parameters `maximum_datetime` (*float*) – New maximum timestamp to configure on the device.

Returns None

setMinimumDateTime(*minimum_datetime*)

Same as setMinimumDatetime

setMinimumDatetime(*minimum_datetime*)

Sets the minimum datetime value allowed by the *TempicoDevice()*.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function sends the 'DTIME:MINimum <timestamp>' command to update the minimum allowed timestamp. If the device accepts the value, it should return a confirmation response. If no response is received, the value is validated by re-reading it from the device.

Parameters `minimum_datetime` (*float*) – New minimum timestamp to configure on the device.

Returns None

setMode(*channel, mode*)

Modifies the measurement mode of the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, mode = 1. Possible values are:

In TP1004:

- 1: Short measurement range. Start-stop times from 12ns to 500ns.
- 2: Large measurement range. Start-stop times from 125ns to 4ms.

In TP1204:

- 1: Short measurement range. Start-stop times from -200ns to 300ns.
- 2: Large measurement range. Start-stop times from -50ns to 4ms.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, and delegates the configuration to the selected *TempicoChannel()*. If the channel is invalid, the function does nothing.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'-'D') to access and configure the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters

- **channel** (*int* or *str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:
 - 1 or 'A' or 'a'

- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'

- **mode** (*int*) – Desired measurement mode for the TDC. Valid values are 1 or 2.

setNumberOfRuns(*number*)

Modifies the number of measurement runs of the TDCs in *TempicoDevice()*.

By default, number of runs = 1 (single measurement).

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*.

Parameters **number** (*int*) – desired number of runs for every TDC. Valid values are from 1 to 1000.

setNumberOfStops(*channel, numberOfStops*)

Modifies the expected number of stop pulses of the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, number of stops = 1 (single start → single stop).

The TDC must receive all the expected number of stops to register them as a valid measurement; otherwise, the measurements are discarded. For extending the valid time range, consider using measurement mode 2.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, and delegates the configuration to the selected *TempicoChannel()*. If the channel is invalid, the function does nothing.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access and configure the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters

- **channel** (*int or str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:
 - 1 or 'A' or 'a'
 - 2 or 'B' or 'b'
 - 3 or 'C' or 'c'
 - 4 or 'D' or 'd'
- **numberOfStops** (*int*) – Desired number of stops for the TDC. Valid values are from 1 to 5.

setStartEdge(*channel, edge_type*)

Sets the edge type used on start pulses of the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, start edge = 'RISE'. Possible values are:

- 'RISE': TDC timing starts on a rising edge of the start pulse.
- 'FALL': TDC timing starts on a falling edge of the start pulse.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, and delegates the configuration to the selected *TempicoChannel()*. If the channel is invalid, the function does nothing.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access and configure the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters

- **channel** (*int or str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:
 - 1 or 'A' or 'a'

- 2 or 'B' or 'b'
- 3 or 'C' or 'c'
- 4 or 'D' or 'd'
- **edge_type** (*str or int*) – Desired start edge type for the TDC. Accepted values are 'RISE', 1, 'RIS' or 'FALL', 0, 'FAL'.

setStartExternalSource(channel)

Sets the start signal source to external for the specified channel.

This function configures the selected channel so that its start signal comes from an external input instead of the internal generator.

Parameters **channel** (*int*) – Channel number to configure.

Returns None

setStartInternalSource(channel)

Sets the start signal source to the internal generator for the specified channel.

This function configures the selected channel so that its start signal is provided by the internal pulse generator instead of an external input.

Parameters **channel** (*int*) – Channel number to configure.

Returns None

setStopEdge(channel, edge_type)

Sets the edge type used on stop pulses of the specified [TempicoChannel\(\)](#).

By default, stop edge = 'RISE'. Possible values are:

- 'RISE': TDC timing ends on a rising edge of the stop pulse.
- 'FALL': TDC timing ends on a falling edge of the stop pulse.

This function requires that a connection is established with the [TempicoDevice\(\)](#), and delegates the configuration to the selected [TempicoChannel\(\)](#). If the channel is invalid, the function does nothing.

This version belongs to the [TempicoDevice\(\)](#) class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access and configure the corresponding [TempicoChannel\(\)](#).

Parameters

- **channel** (*int or str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:
 - 1 or 'A' or 'a'
 - 2 or 'B' or 'b'
 - 3 or 'C' or 'c'
 - 4 or 'D' or 'd'
- **edge_type** (*str or int*) – Desired stop edge type for the TDC. Accepted values are 'RISE', 1, 'RIS' or 'FALL', 0, 'FAL'.

setStopExternalSource(channel)

Sets the stop signal source to external for the specified channel.

This function configures the selected channel so that its stop signal comes from an external input instead of the internal generator.

Parameters **channel** (*int*) – Channel number to configure.

Returns None

setStopInternalSource(channel)

Sets the stop signal source to the internal generator for the specified channel.

This function configures the selected channel so that its stop signal is provided by the internal pulse generator instead of an external input.

Parameters **channel** (*int*) – Channel number to configure.

Returns None

setStopMask(channel, stop_mask_in_us)

Modifies the stop mask time of the specified *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, in TP1004 stop mask = 0us (no masking). By default, in TP1204 stop mask = -0.25us (no masking).

The stop mask defines the period (in microseconds) after receiving a start pulse during which stop pulses are ignored. This can help suppress unwanted noise or early signals.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, and delegates the configuration to the selected *TempicoChannel()*. If the channel is invalid, the function does nothing.

This version belongs to the *TempicoDevice()* class and requires specifying the channel number or label ('A'–'D') to access and configure the corresponding *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters

- **channel** (*int* or *str*) – Channel identifier. Accepted values are:
 - 1 or 'A' or 'a'
 - 2 or 'B' or 'b'
 - 3 or 'C' or 'c'
 - 4 or 'D' or 'd'
- **stop_mask_in_us** (*float*) – Desired stop mask time in microseconds. Valid values are from -0.25 to 4000.

setThresholdVoltage(desired_voltage)

Changes the threshold voltage on the rising edge of start and stops inputs of TDCs in the *TempicoDevice()*.

Start and stop inputs are coupled to 50 ohms.

By default, threshold voltage = 1.00V (recommended for TTL>2.5V).

All inputs are 5V tolerant.

Gate input. This parameter does not have effect on the gate input. Gate input accepts 3.3V TTL and 5V TTL signals.

- When gate is disconnected, system is enabled.
- When gate is connected to 0V, system is disabled.
- When gate is connected to 3.3V/5V, system is enabled.

To validate the actual threshold voltage applied, method *getThresholdVoltage()* should be called.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*.

Parameters **desired_voltage** (*float*) – desired start and stop inputs threshold voltage. Valid parameters are MINimum|MAXimum|DOWN|UP or a number from 0.90 to 1.60.

setThresholdVoltageToMaximum()

Sets to the maximum valid value the threshold voltage on the rising edge of start and stops inputs of TDCs in the *TempicoDevice()*.

To validate the actual threshold voltage applied, method *getThresholdVoltage()* should be called.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*.

Parameters (none) –

setThresholdVoltageToMinimum()

Sets to the minimum valid value the threshold voltage on the rising edge of start and stops inputs of TDCs in the *TempicoDevice()*.

To validate the actual threshold voltage applied, method *getThresholdVoltage()* should be called.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*.

Parameters (none) –

waitAndReadMessage(wait_time_ms=1)

Waits the specified time, and then reads pending messages sent by a *TempicoDevice()* from its serial port, if any.

If no message is received, it does not wait for a port timeout.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*.

Parameters wait_time_ms (int, optional) – Waiting time, in milliseconds. Defaults to 1.

Returns read message.

Return type str

writeMessage(message)

Writes a message to a *TempicoDevice()* in its serial port.

If a response is expected after writing a message, the *readMessage()* method should be called afterwards to obtain the response.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*.

Parameters message (str) – message to be sent.

1.3 TempicoChannel class

class pyTempico.core.TempicoChannel(id_device, ch_num)

Single channel on a Tempico Device.

To modify or access attributes, **please use methods**. For example, to get average cycles on channel 2,

```
>>> my_tempico_device_object.ch2.getAverageCycles()
```

or, as an alternative, send the channel number as a parameter

```
>>> my_tempico_device_object.getAverageCycles(2)
```

Changing attributes without using methods, do not change the actual parameters in the device.

Accessing attributes without using methods, returns values registered in local memory that may not be updated.

id_tempico_channel

Unique identifier for a *TempicoChannel()* object.

Type int

id_tempico_device

Identifier of the *TempicoDevice()* linked to this *TempicoChannel()* object.

Type int

average_cycles

Average cycles.

Type int

channel_number

Number of the channel in the device (1=A, 2=B,...).

Type int

enable

True when the channel is enabled.

Type bool

mode

Measurement mode. 1|2.

- 1: Short measurement range. Start-stop times from 12ns to 500ns.
- 2: Large measurement range. Start-stop times from 125ns to 4ms.

Type int

number_of_stops

Number of stop pulses expected after a start pulse arrives. 1..5.

Type int

parent_tempico_device

Pointer reference to parent object of *TempicoDevice()* class.

Type *TempicoDevice*

start_edge

Edge type on the start pulse used to begin timing. RISE|FALL.

Type str

stop_edge

Edge type on the stop pulses used to end timing. RISE|FALL.

Type str

stop_mask

Time that stop pulses are ignored after receiving a start pulse on the TDC. Value in microseconds. 0..4000.

Type int

disableChannel()

Disables a TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, channels are enabled.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()* of the *TempicoChannel()*.

To validate the status of the channel, method *isEnabled()* may be used.

Parameters (none) –

enableChannel()

Enables a TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, channels are enabled.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()* of the *TempicoChannel()*.

To validate the status of the channel, method *isEnabled()* may be used.

Parameters (none) –

getAverageCycles()

Returns the average cycles of the TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, average cycles = 1 (no multi-cycle averaging).

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function request the device for the value. If not, the most recent value is returned.

Parameters (none) –

Returns Number of average cycles.

Return type integer

getDelay()

Returns the internal delay value for this channel, in picoseconds.

In TP10 devices, this value is zero. In TP12 devices, this value is read from the device.

This function queries the device using the ‘CONFigure:CHx:DElay?’ command to obtain the internal delay assigned to the current channel. If the connection is not open or the hardware version is not supported, an informational message is printed.

Parameters None –

Returns internal delay of the stop channel with respect to the start, in picoseconds. Returns -1 when fails.

Return type float

getMode()

Returns the measurement mode of the TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, mode = 1.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function request the device for the value. If not, the most recent value is returned.

Parameters (none) –

Returns

Mode. Possible values are,

In TP1004:

- 1: Short measurement range. Start-stop times from 12ns to 500ns.
- 2: Large measurement range. Start-stop times from 125ns to 4ms.

In TP1204:

- 1: Short measurement range. Start-stop times from -200ns to 300ns.

- 2: Large measurement range. Start-stop times from -50ns to 4ms.

Return type integer

getNumberOfStops()

Returns the expected number of stop pulses of the TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, number of stops = 1 (single start -> single stop).

The TDC must receive all the expected number of stops to register them as a valid measurement; otherwise, the measurements are discarded.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function request the device for the value. If not, the most recent value is returned.

Parameters (none) –

Returns Number of stops.

Return type integer

getStartEdge()

Returns the edge type used on start pulses of the TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, start edge = 'RISE'.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function request the device for the value. If not, the most recent value is returned.

Parameters (none) –

Returns

start edge type. Possible values are,

- 'RISE': TDC timing starts on a rising edge of the start pulse.
- 'FALL': TDC timing starts on a falling edge of the start pulse.

Return type string

getStartSource()

Returns the start signal source for this channel.

This function determines whether the start signal of the current channel comes from the internal generator or from an external input.

Internal pulse generator is available in TP12 devices.

Parameters None –

Returns Signal source identifier ("INternal" or "EXternal").

Return type str

getState()

Returns the state of a *TempicoChannel()*.

This function is used to validate if a reset or an abort command has been successfully applied.

Some possible states are:

- 0: disabled.
- 1: idle, enabled.
- 10: processing a reset.
- 11: processing an abort.

other states are related with the measurement process.

Parameters (none) –

Returns state.

Return type int

getStatus()

Returns the internal status of a *TempicoChannel()*.

This function is used to obtain the state of a channel, used to validate if a reset or an abort command has been successfully applied.

Parameters (none) –

Returns status fields and values.

Return type dict

getStopEdge()

Returns the edge type used on stop pulses of the TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, stop edge = 'RISE'.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function request the device for the value. If not, the most recent value is returned.

Parameters (none) –

Returns

stop edge type. Possible values are,

- 'RISE': TDC timing ends on a rising edge of the stop pulse.
- 'FALL': TDC timing ends on a falling edge of the stop pulse.

Return type string

getStopMask()

Returns the time that stop pulses are ignored after receiving a start pulse on the TDC *TempicoChannel()*. In microseconds.

By default, in TP1004 stop mask = 0us (no masking). By default, in TP1204 stop mask = -0.25us (no masking).

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function request the device for the value. If not, the most recent value is returned.

Parameters (none) –

Returns stop mask time, in microseconds.

Return type float

getStopSource()

Returns the stop signal source for this channel.

This function determines whether the stop signal of the current channel comes from the internal generator or from an external input.

Internal pulse generator is available in TP12 devices.

Parameters None –

Returns Signal source identifier ("INternal" or "EXternal").

Return type str

isEnabled()

Returns if a TDC *TempicoChannel()* is enabled.

By default, channels are enabled.

If the connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()*, this function request the device for the value.
If not, the most recent value is returned.

Parameters (none) –

Returns True, when TDC channel is enabled.

Return type bool

setAverageCycles(number)

Modifies the average cycles of the TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, average cycles = 1 (no multi-cycle averaging).

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()* of the *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters **number** (int) – desired average cycles for the TDC. Valid values are 1|2|4|8|16|32|64|128.

setMode(number)

Modifies the measurement mode of the TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, mode = 1. Possible values are,

In TP1004:

- 1: Short measurement range. Start-stop times from 12ns to 500ns.
- 2: Large measurement range. Start-stop times from 125ns to 4ms.

In TP1204:

- 1: Short measurement range. Start-stop times from -200ns to 300ns.
- 2: Large measurement range. Start-stop times from -50ns to 4ms.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()* of the *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters **number** (int) – desired measurement mode for the TDC. Valid values are 1 or 2.

setNumberOfStops(number)

Modifies the expected number of stop pulses of the TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, number of stops = 1 (single start -> single stop).

The TDC must receive all the expected number of stops to register them as a valid measurement; otherwise, the measurements are discarded. For extending the valid time range, consider using measurement mode 2.

This function requires that a connection is established with the *TempicoDevice()* of the *TempicoChannel()*.

Parameters **number** (int) – desired number of stops for the TDC. Valid values are from 1 to 5.

setStartEdge(edge_type)

Sets the edge type used on start pulses of the TDC *TempicoChannel()*.

By default, start edge = 'RISE'. Possible values are,

- 'RISE': TDC timing starts on a rising edge of the start pulse.

- 'FALL': TDC timing starts on a falling edge of the start pulse.

This function requires that a connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()` of the `TempicoChannel()`.

Parameters `edge_type` (*str*) – desired start edge type for the TDC. Valid values are 'RISE', 1, 'FALL', 0.

setStartExternalSource()

Sets the start signal source to external (only for TP12 devices).

This function configures the start input of the current channel so that its signal comes from an external source instead of the internal generator.

Parameters `None` –

Returns `None`

setStartInternalSource()

Sets the start signal source to the internal generator (only for TP12 devices).

This function configures the start input of the current channel so that its signal is provided by the internal pulse generator instead of an external source.

Parameters `None` –

Returns `None`

setStopEdge(*edge_type*)

Sets the edge type used on stop pulses of the TDC `TempicoChannel()`.

By default, stop edge = 'RISE'. Possible values are,

- 'RISE': TDC timing ends on a rising edge of the stop pulse.
- 'FALL': TDC timing ends on a falling edge of the stop pulse.

This function requires that a connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()` of the `TempicoChannel()`.

Parameters `edge_type` (*str*) – desired stop edge type for the TDC. Valid values are 'RISE', 1, 'FALL', 0.

setStopExternalSource()

Sets the stop signal source to external (only for TP12 devices).

This function configures the stop input of the current channel so that its signal comes from an external source instead of the internal generator.

Parameters `None` –

Returns `None`

setStopInternalSource()

Sets the stop signal source to the internal generator (only for TP12 devices).

This function configures the stop input of the current channel so that its signal is provided by the internal pulse generator instead of an external source.

Parameters `None` –

Returns `None`

setStopMask(*stop_mask_in_us*)

Modifies the time that stop pulses are ignored after receiving a start pulse on the TDC `TempicoChannel()`.

By default, in TP1004 stop mask = 0us (no masking). By default, in TP1204 stop mask = -0.25us (no masking).

This function requires that a connection is established with the `TempicoDevice()` of the `TempicoChannel()`.

Parameters `stop_mask_in_us` (*float*) – desired stop mask for the TDC, in microseconds.

Valid values are from -0.25 to 4000.

EXAMPLES

2.1 Settings examples

Examples on how to read and change settings on a Tausand Tempico.

2.1.1 readIdentifiersExample.py

```
# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""readIdentifiersExample

    Created on Thu Jan 29 11:03 2026

    Connects to a Tausand Tempico device and reads its identifier strings.

    Instructions:
        * before running this example, pyTempico package must be installed.
        * change 'my_port' to your corresponding port.
        * run.

    You do not need a connected signal to run this example.

    This example:
        * opens connection to the device,
        * uses get methods to read identifier strings,
        * closes connection.

    | @author: David Guzman, Tausand Electronics
    | dguzman@tausand.com
    | https://www.tausand.com
"""
import pyTempico

my_port = 'COM7' #change this port to your Tempico device's port

my_device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(my_port)    #create object

#Open connection
print('opening connection with device in port',my_port)
my_device.open()    #open connection with device
```

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```

if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

#Use get methods to obtain identifier strings of a Tausand Tempico device
my_idn = my_device.getIdn()
my_model_idn = my_device.getModelIdn()
my_serial_number = my_device.getSerialNumber()
my_firmware = my_device.getFirmware()

#Print string identifiers
print('\nIDN string:\t\t',my_idn)
print('Model IDN:\t\t',my_model_idn)
print('Serial number:\t',my_serial_number)
print('Firmware:\t\t',my_firmware)

#Close connection
my_device.close()
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('\nconnection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('\nconnection with my_device is close')

```

2.1.2 readSettingsExample.py

```

# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""readSettingsExample

    Created on Tue May  7 09:49 2024

    Connects to a Tausand Tempico device and reads its settings.

    Instructions:
        * before running this example, pyTempico package must be installed.
        * change 'my_port' to your corresponding port.
        * run.

    / @author: David Guzman, Tausand Electronics
    / dguzman@tausand.com
    / https://www.tausand.com
    """

import pyTempico

my_port = 'COM7' #change this port to your Tempico device's port

my_device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(my_port) #create object

print('opening connection with device in port',my_port)

```

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```

my_device.open()                #open connection with device
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

print('\n1) reading general getSettings')
my_settings = my_device.getSettings()
print('settings:')
print(my_settings)

print('\n2) reading specific settings')
print('NumberOfRuns:', my_device.getNumberOfRuns())
print('ThresholdVoltage:', my_device.getThresholdVoltage())

print('\n2.1) reading channel specific settings using direct channel method')
print('Ch1 AverageCycles:', my_device.ch1.getAverageCycles())
print('Ch2 AverageCycles:', my_device.ch2.getAverageCycles())
print('Ch3 AverageCycles:', my_device.ch3.getAverageCycles())
print('Ch4 AverageCycles:', my_device.ch4.getAverageCycles())
print('Ch1 Mode:', my_device.ch1.getMode())
print('Ch1 NumberOfStops:', my_device.ch1.getNumberOfStops())
print('Ch1 isEnabled:', my_device.ch1.isEnabled())
print('Ch1 StartEdge:', my_device.ch1.getStartEdge())
print('Ch1 StopEdge:', my_device.ch1.getStopEdge())
print('Ch1 StopMask:', my_device.ch1.getStopMask())

print('\n2.2) reading channel specific settings via device method')
print('Ch1 AverageCycles:', my_device.getAverageCycles(1))
print('Ch2 AverageCycles:', my_device.getAverageCycles(2))
print('Ch3 AverageCycles:', my_device.getAverageCycles(3))
print('Ch4 AverageCycles:', my_device.getAverageCycles(4))
print('Ch1 Mode:', my_device.getMode(1))
print('Ch1 NumberOfStops:', my_device.getNumberOfStops(1))
print('Ch1 isEnabled:', my_device.isEnabled(1))
print('Ch1 StartEdge:', my_device.getStartEdge(1))
print('Ch1 StopEdge:', my_device.getStopEdge(1))
print('Ch1 StopMask:', my_device.getStopMask(1))

print('\nclosing connection with device in port',my_port)
my_device.close()                #close connection with device
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

```

2.1.3 writeSettingsExample.py

```
# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""writeSettingsExample

Created on Tue Jul 14 16:42 2025

This example connects to a Tausand Tempico device and demonstrates how to
read and modify its basic settings, including average cycles, number of stops,
and stop mask - both using direct channel access and the main device interface.

Instructions:
    - Make sure the pyTempico package is installed.
    - Replace 'COM5' with the appropriate serial port for your Tempico device.
    - Run the script.

    | @author: Joan Amaya, Tausand Electronics
    | jamaya@tausand.com
    | https://www.tausand.com
"""

import pyTempico

# Set your device port here
my_port = 'COM5'
my_device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(my_port)

print(f"\nOpening connection on port {my_port}...")
my_device.open()

if my_device.isOpen():
    print("Device connection is open.")
else:
    print("Failed to open device connection.")

# Reset to default settings before making changes
print("\nResetting device to default settings...")
my_device.reset()

# Read initial settings
print("\n[1] Reading default settings with my_device.getSettings():")
settings = my_device.getSettings()
print(settings)

# Modify average cycles (Channel 1)
print("\n[2] Setting average cycles on Channel 1 using direct channel method (Channel 1 → 4 cycles):")
my_device.ch1.setAverageCycles(4)
print(f"New value: {my_device.ch1.getAverageCycles()}")

# Reset and apply the same setting using device-level method
print("\nResetting...")
my_device.reset()
```

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```

print("\n[3] Setting average cycles via device method (Channel 1 → 8 cycles):")
my_device.setAverageCycles(1, 8)
print(f"Verified: {my_device.getAverageCycles(1)}")

# Modify number of stops
print("\nResetting...")
my_device.reset()
print("\n[4] Setting number of stops on Channel 1 using direct method (Channel 1 → 5
↳ stops):")
my_device.ch1.setNumberOfStops(5)
print(f"New value: {my_device.ch1.getNumberOfStops()}")

# Reset and set using device method
print("\nResetting...")
my_device.reset()
print("\n[5] Setting number of stops via device method (Channel 1 → 4 stops):")
my_device.setNumberOfStops(1, 4)
print(f"Verified: {my_device.getNumberOfStops(1)}")

# Modify stop mask
print("\nResetting...")
my_device.reset()
print("\n[6] Setting stop mask on 1000 us in Channel 1 using direct method (Channel 1 →
↳ 1000):")
my_device.ch1.setStopMask(1000)
print(f"New value: {my_device.ch1.getStopMask()}")

# Reset and set using device method
print("\nResetting...")
my_device.reset()
print("\n[7] Setting stop mask on 2000 us via device method (Channel 1 → 2000):")
my_device.setStopMask(1, 2000)
print(f"Verified: {my_device.getStopMask(1)}")

# Close connection
print(f"\nClosing connection on port {my_port}...")
my_device.close()

if my_device.isOpen():
    print("Connection is still open.")
else:
    print("Connection closed successfully.")

```

2.1.4 dateTimeExample.py

```
# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""dateTimeExample

This script demonstrates how to connect to a Tausand Tempico device and
perform several operations related to time management and measurement flow.

Instructions:
    * ensure `pyTempico` is installed,
    * change `my_port` to your corresponding port,
    * run the script.

You do not need a connected signal to run this example.

This example:
    * opens connection to the device,
    * reset and configure channels,
    * read and synchronize time,
    * modifies allowed datetime range,
    * performs a measurement,
    * closes connection.

    / @author: Joan Amaya, Tausand Electronics
    / jamaya@tausand.com
    / https://www.tausand.com
"""
import pyTempico

my_port = 'COM5' #change this port to your Tempico device's port

my_device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(my_port)    #create object

print('opening connection with device in port',my_port)
my_device.open()    #open connection with device
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

print('\nreseting device. This clears previous measurements, and changes settings to
↳default values.')
my_device.reset()

#Enable channel 1, disable channels 2-4
print('\ndisabling channels 2-4.')
my_device.ch1.enableChannel()    #optional, since enabled by default
my_device.ch2.disableChannel()
my_device.ch3.disableChannel()
my_device.ch4.disableChannel()

print("\nWe want to see the current time in seconds with microsecond resolution. By
↳default, this time is taken when the device is powered on.\n")
```

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```

print(f"{my_device.getDateTime()}")

print("\nThis time can also be printed in a formatted date style, which will become more_
↳useful later on.\n")
print(f"{my_device.getDateTime(True)}")

print("\nThis time can be synchronized by the user, who provides a timestamp in seconds_
↳with microsecond resolution.\n")

print("\nHowever, this timestamp must fall within the minimum and maximum limits_
↳accepted by the device.\n")
print(f"Maximum value with my_device.getMaximumDatetime(): {my_device.
↳getMaximumDatetime()}")
print(f"Formatted (with True): {my_device.getMaximumDatetime(True)}")
print(f"Minimum value with my_device.getMinimumDatetime(): {my_device.
↳getMinimumDatetime()}")
print(f"Formatted (with True): {my_device.getMinimumDatetime(True)}")

print("\nNow that we know the allowed range, we'll configure a custom time value.\n")
print("Setting the time using: my_device.setDateTime(3102462800.0)")
my_device.setDateTime(3102462800.0)

print("\nWe can now verify that the time was correctly synchronized.\n")
print(f"Device time via my_device.getDateTime(): {my_device.getDateTime()}")

print("\nAlso we can synchronize the time with our pc, using the same function without_
↳parameter.\n")
print("Setting the time using: my_device.setDateTime()")
my_device.setDateTime()

print("\nWe can now verify that the time was correctly synchronized.\n")
print(f"Device time via my_device.getDateTime(): {my_device.getDateTime()}")
print(f"With a date format now my_device.getDateTime(True): {my_device.getDateTime(True)}
↳")

print("\nIf we want to use a timestamp outside the current limits, we can update the_
↳allowed range.\n")
print(f"Setting new maximum with my_device.setMaximumDatetime(4103462800.0).")
my_device.setMaximumDatetime(4103462800.0)
print(f"Setting new minimum with my_device.setMinimumDatetime(1576854800.0).")
my_device.setMinimumDatetime(1576854800.0)

print("\nNow we can retrieve the new minimum and maximum values.\n")
print(f"New maximum: my_device.getMaximumDatetime(): {my_device.getMaximumDatetime()}")
print(f"New minimum: my_device.getMinimumDatetime(): {my_device.getMinimumDatetime()}")

print("\nThese values are useful to determine when a start signal was received. We will_
↳now perform a measurement - a connected start signal is required.\n")

print("Disabling channels 2-4.")
my_device.ch1.enableChannel()

```

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```

my_device.ch2.disableChannel()
my_device.ch3.disableChannel()
my_device.ch4.disableChannel()

print("\nStarting a measurement.\n")
my_device.measure()

print("my_device.fetch():")
data = my_device.fetch()
print(data)

print("\nNote that the start time aligns with the synchronized time. Additionally, we
↳ can retrieve the time of the last start and the last synchronization (i.e., from
↳ setDateTime()).\n")
print(f"Last start via my_device.getLastStart(): {my_device.getLastStart()}")
print(f"Last start (formatted): {my_device.getLastStart(True)}")
print(f"Last synchronization via my_device.getLastSync(): {my_device.getLastSync()}")
print(f"Last synchronization (formatted): {my_device.getLastSync(True)}")

my_device.close()
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

```

2.2 Measurement examples

Examples on how to measure start-stop times with a Tausand Tempico.

2.2.1 singleMeasureExample.py

```

# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""singleMeasureExample

Created on Tue May  7 09:23 2024

Connects to a Tausand Tempico device, starts a measurement and reads the
results.

Instructions:
    * before running this example, pyTempico package must be installed.
    * change 'my_port' to your corresponding port.
    * connect signals to your Tempico Device. If no signals are measured,
      this example will return an empty data array.
    * run.

/ @author: David Guzman, Tausand Electronics
/ dguzman@tausand.com
/ https://www.tausand.com

```

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```

"""

import pyTempico

my_port = 'COM16' #change this port to your Tempico device's port

my_device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(my_port) #create object

print('opening connection with device in port',my_port)
my_device.open() #open connection with device
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

print('sending a measure request to device')
data = my_device.measure() #starts a measurement, and saves response in 'data'
print('measured data, in ps:',data)

my_device.close() #close connection with device
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

```

2.2.2 modeTwoMeasureExample.py

```

# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""modeTwoMeasureExample

    Created on Tue May  7 11:42 2024

    Connects to a Tausand Tempico device, changes settings to measure only in
    channel 1 in mode 2 (125ns-4ms mode). Then, starts a measurement and reads
    the results.

    Instructions:
        * before running this example, pyTempico package must be installed.
        * change 'my_port' to your corresponding port.
        * connect signals to your Tempico Device. If no signals are measured,
        this example will return an empty data array.
        * run.

    / @author: David Guzman, Tausand Electronics
    / dguzman@tausand.com
    / https://www.tausand.com
"""

import pyTempico

```

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```

my_port = 'COM16' #change this port to your Tempico device's port

my_device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(my_port)    #create object

print('opening connection with device in port',my_port)
my_device.open()                               #open connection with device
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

print('\nreseting device. This clears previous measurements, and changes settings to
↪default values.')
my_device.reset()

#Enable channel 1, disable channels 2-4
print('\ndisabling channels 2-4.')
my_device.ch1.enableChannel()    #optional, since enabled by default
my_device.ch2.disableChannel()
my_device.ch3.disableChannel()
my_device.ch4.disableChannel()

print('\nchanging measurement mode in channel 1 to mode 2')
my_device.ch1.setMode(2)        #default mode is 1, changing to mode 2
#verify
print('my_device.ch1.getMode():',my_device.ch1.getMode())

print('\nsending a measure request to device')
data = my_device.measure()      #starts a measurement, and saves response in 'data'
print('measured data, in ps:',data)

print('fetch:',my_device.fetch()) #fetch most recent data

my_device.close()               #close connection with device
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

```

2.2.3 numberOfRunsMeasureExample.py

```

# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""numberOfRunsMeasureExample

    Created on Tue Jul 14 16:42 2025

    Example script for measuring with a Tausand Tempico device using extended
    number of runs (1000), and using Mode 2 (125 ns - 4 ms range) on Channel 1.

    This example connects to the Tempico device, configures it to only enable

```

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Channel 1, sets the measurement mode to Mode 2, and adjusts the number of runs (measurements) to 1000. It then starts a single measurement operation and reads the resulting data.

The key feature demonstrated here is the use of ``setNumberOfRuns(1000)``, which tells the device to internally perform 1000 measurements in response to a single call to ``measure()``. This is ideal for bulk acquisition workflows where multiple time intervals are collected automatically.

Instructions:

- Make sure the ``pyTempico`` package is installed.
- Replace ``COM5`` with the serial port corresponding to your device.
- Connect appropriate start/stop signals to the Tempico device.
- Run the script. If no signals are present, the measurement will return an empty array.

```
| @author: Joan Amaya, Tausand Electronics
| jamaya@tausand.com
| https://www.tausand.com
"""
import pyTempico

my_port = 'COM5' #change this port to your Tempico device's port

my_device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(my_port)    #create object

print('opening connection with device in port',my_port)
my_device.open()                               #open connection with device
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

print('\nreseting device. This clears previous measurements, and changes settings to
↳ default values.')
my_device.reset()

#Enable channel 1, disable channels 2-4
print('\ndisabling channels 2-4.')
my_device.ch1.enableChannel()    #optional, since enabled by default
my_device.ch2.disableChannel()
my_device.ch3.disableChannel()
my_device.ch4.disableChannel()

print('\nchanging measurement mode in channel 1 to mode 2')
my_device.ch1.setMode(2)        #default mode is 1, changing to mode 2
#verify
print('my_device.ch1.getMode():',my_device.ch1.getMode())

print('\nchanging number of runs to 1000, this setting is applied to every channel in
↳ the device')
my_device.setNumberOfRuns(1000)    #default number of run is 1, changing to number of
↳ run 1000
```

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```

#verify
print('my_device.getNumberOfRuns():',my_device.getNumberOfRuns())

print('\nsending a measure request to device')
data = my_device.measure()  #starts a measurement, and saves response in 'data'
print('measured data, in ps:',data)

print('fetch:',my_device.fetch()) #fetch most recent data
print('\nIf a measurement was succesful, you will see 1000 different measurements with a
↪single call of the measurement function.')

my_device.close()
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

```

2.2.4 numberOfStopsMeasureExample.py

```

# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""numberOfStopsMeasureExample

    Created on Tue Jul 14 16:42 2025

    Example script for measuring with a Tausand Tempico device using Mode 2
    (125 ns - 4 ms range) on Channel 1, with multiple stops per measurement.

    This example connects to the Tempico device, enables only Channel 1, sets
    the measurement mode to Mode 2, and changes the number of stops to 5. It
    then starts a measurement and prints the result.

    The key feature demonstrated here is the use of `setNumberOfStops(5)`,
    which configures the device to collect **5 stop events** after a single
    start signal during each measurement cycle. This is useful for analyzing
    multiple photon arrivals or signal repetitions after a common trigger.

    Instructions:
    - Make sure the `pyTempico` package is installed.
    - Replace `COM5` with the serial port corresponding to your device.
    - Connect a periodic signal to the **start input**, and the signal to
      be measured to the stop input of Channel 1.
    - Run the script. If no signals are received, the measurement will
      return an empty array.

    | @author: Joan Amaya, Tausand Electronics
    | jamaya@tausand.com
    | https://www.tausand.com
    """
import pyTempico

```

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```

my_port = 'COM5' #change this port to your Tempico device's port

my_device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(my_port)    #create object

print('opening connection with device in port',my_port)
my_device.open()          #open connection with device
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

print('\nreseting device. This clears previous measurements, and changes settings to
↳ default values.')
my_device.reset()

#Enable channel 1, disable channels 2-4
print('\ndisabling channels 2-4.')
my_device.ch1.enableChannel()    #optional, since enabled by default
my_device.ch2.disableChannel()
my_device.ch3.disableChannel()
my_device.ch4.disableChannel()

print('\nchanging measurement mode in channel 1 to mode 2')
my_device.ch1.setMode(2)    #default mode is 1, changing to mode 2
#verify
print('my_device.ch1.getMode():',my_device.ch1.getMode())

print('\nchanging number of stops in channel 1 to 5')
my_device.ch1.setNumberOfStops(5)    #default number of stops is 1, changing number of
↳ stops to 5
#verify
print('my_device.ch1.getNumberOfStops():',my_device.ch1.getNumberOfStops())

print('\nsending a measure request to device')
data = my_device.measure()    #starts a measurement, and saves response in 'data'
print('measured data, in ps:',data)

print('fetch:',my_device.fetch()) #fetch most recent data
print('\nYou will see 5 stop data per measurement, these stops are captured after the
↳ same start signal.')

my_device.close()
if my_device.isOpen():
    print('connection with my_device is open')
else:
    print('connection with my_device is close')

```

2.2.5 multipleMeasureSingleChExample.py

```
# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""
multipleMeasureSingleChExample

    Created on Mon Feb 16 10:35:56 2026

    Connects to a Tausand Tempico device, starts a sequence of multiple
    measurements on a single channel, and reads the results. Results are
    written in a csv file.

    Instructions:
        * before running this example, pandas and pyTempico packages must be installed.
        * change 'my_port' to your corresponding port.
        * (optional) change parameters 'mode', 'number_of_measurements'
        and 'number_of_runs'.
        * connect signals to your Tempico Device. If no signals are measured,
        this example will return an empty data array.
        * run.

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"""
import pyTempico
import pandas as pd
from datetime import datetime

my_port = 'COM7' #change this port to your Tempico device's port
my_device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(my_port) #create object
mode = 1 #valid modes: 1 or 2. (TOF up to 250ns, or TOF from 125ns up to 4ms)
number_of_measurements = 50
number_of_runs = 100 #valid values: 1 to 1000

def MeasureStartStopSingleCh(selected_ch):
    try:
        selected_ch = int(selected_ch)
        if (selected_ch < 1) or (selected_ch > numch):
            selected_ch=""
            raise Exception("Invalid input.")
    except ValueError:
        selected_ch=""
        print("Invalid input.")

    selected_ch_letter = chr(ord('A')+selected_ch-1)
    print('\nPreparing to measure start-stop TOF in channel '+selected_ch_letter+'.')
    print('Connect signals into start and stop'+selected_ch_letter+'.')
    print("Are signals connected (y/n):")
    user_input = input()
    data = []
```

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```

if ((user_input == 'y') or (user_input == 'Y')):
    for i in range(1,numch+1):
        if i == selected_ch:
            #enable selected channel
            my_device.enableChannel(i)
        else:
            #disable unselected channels
            my_device.disableChannel(i)

my_device.setMode(selected_ch, mode)
my_device.setNumberOfRuns(number_of_runs)
print('Measure started. Running '+str(number_of_measurements),end='')
print(' measurements, each of '+str(number_of_runs)+' runs.')

#synchronize Tempico's datetime with PC's datetime
my_device.setDateTime()

#calibrate before starting a measurement
my_device.calibrateDelay()

print('Progress:')
for k in range(1,number_of_measurements+1):
    #repeat number_of_measurements times the measurment
    percentage=100.0*k/number_of_measurements
    print(f"\r{percentage:4.0f}%",end='')
    this_data = my_device.measure() #starts a measurement, and saves response_
    in 'data'
    data = data + this_data #appending

df = pd.DataFrame(data, columns = ["ch", "run", "datetime", "tof_ps"])
print('\nMeasure completed.')

print('\nTime-Of-Flight statistics:')
samples = len(df)
tof_mean = round(df['tof_ps'].mean(),2)
tof_median = df['tof_ps'].median()
tof_std = round(df['tof_ps'].std(),2)
tof_max = df['tof_ps'].max()
tof_min = df['tof_ps'].min()
print(f" samples:    \t{samples:14d}")
print(f" mean (ps):   \t{tof_mean:17.2f}")
print(f" median (ps): \t{tof_median:14.0f}")
print(f" std (ps):    \t{tof_std:17.2f}")
print(f" max (ps):    \t{tof_max:14.0f}")
print(f" min (ps):    \t{tof_min:14.0f}")

#build csv file name
dt_string=datetime.today().strftime('%Y%m%d%H%M')
csv_file_name='tempico_tof_ch'+str(selected_ch)+'_'+dt_string+'.csv'

#write header with device details into csv file
my_header = {

```

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```

        'label': ['Datetime', 'Tempico model', 'Serial number', 'Firmware', 'mode'],
        'value': [datetime.today().strftime('%Y-%m-%d %H:%M'), my_device.
↪getModelIdn(), my_device.getSerialNumber(), my_device.getFirmware(), my_device.
↪getMode(selected_ch)]
    }
    header_df = pd.DataFrame(my_header)
    header_df.to_csv(csv_file_name,header=False,index=False) #no printing column
↪names or row indexes

    #write data statistics into csv file
    my_stats = {
        'label': ['samples','tof_ps mean','tof_ps median','tof_ps standard deviation
↪','tof_ps maximum','tof_ps minimum'],
        'value': [samples, tof_mean, tof_median, tof_std, tof_max, tof_min]
    }
    stats_df = pd.DataFrame(my_stats)
    stats_df.to_csv(csv_file_name,header=False,index=False,mode='a') #no printing
↪column names or row indexes, mode 'append'

    #write dataset into file
    df.to_csv(csv_file_name,mode='a') #mode 'append'
    print('\nData saved in '+csv_file_name)

else:
    print('Measurement cancelled.')

#####      MAIN      #####

try:
    print('opening connection with device in port',my_port)
    my_device.open()          #open connection with device
    if my_device.isOpen():
        print('connection with my_device is open')
    else:
        print('connection with my_device is close')
        raise Exception("Failed opening a conection in port "+my_port)

    numch = my_device.number_of_channels

    print('\nSelect a stop channel to measure (1 to '+str(numch)+'):')
    user_input = input()

    MeasureStartStopSingleCh(user_input) #call measurement routine

    my_device.close()
    if my_device.isOpen():
        print('\nconnection with my_device is open')
    else:
        print('\nconnection with my_device is close')

```

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```

except Exception as e:
    print(e)

finally:
    if my_device.isOpen():
        my_device.close() #close a connection, if it is still open

```

2.3 TP1200 examples

Examples specific for Tausand Tempico TP1200 devices.

2.3.1 calibrateExample.py

```

# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""calibrateExample

Created on Thu Jan 29 11:26 2026

This script demonstrates how to calibrate a Tausand Tempico TP1200 device.

In TP1000 the theoretical hardware delay is 0ns. Calibration has no effect.
In TP1200 the theoretical hardware delay is 250ns. Calibration measures the
actual hardware delay, and adjusts the measurement values in consequence.

Instructions:
    * before running this example, pyTempico package must be installed.
    * change 'my_port' to your corresponding port.
    * run.

You do not need a connected signal to run this example.

This example:
    * opens connection to the device,
    * resets the device (optional step),
    * reads current hardware delays,
    * calibrates,
    * reads updated hardware delays,
    * closes connection.

/ @author: David Guzman, Tausand Electronics
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/ https://www.tausand.com
"""
import pyTempico

my_port = 'COM7' #change this port to your Tempico device's port

my_device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(my_port) #create object

```

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```

try:
    print('opening connection with device in port',my_port)
    my_device.open()           #open connection with device
    if my_device.isOpen():
        print('connection with my_device is open')
    else:
        print('connection with my_device is close')
        raise Exception("Failed opening a conection in port "+my_port)

    print('\n1) Reseting device. This clears previous measurements, and changes settings_
↪to default values.')
    my_device.reset()

    #get the number of channels of the connected device
    my_number_of_channels = my_device.number_of_channels

    #Read current inner delay in each channel
    print('\n2) Read inner start-stop hardware delay.')
    for i in range(1,my_number_of_channels+1): #from 1 to 4 inclusive if TP1xx4
        print('        delay in channel',i,end='\t')
        print(my_device.getDelay(i),end='')
        print('ps')

    #Get last calibration time
    print(f"\nLast delay calibration via my_device.getLastDelaySync(): {my_device.
↪getLastDelaySync()}")
    print(f"Last delay calibration (formatted): {my_device.getLastDelaySync(True)}")

    #Read current inner delay in each channel
    print('\n3) Request a calibration.')
    my_device.calibrateDelay()

    print('\n4) Read again inner start-stop hardware delay, after calibration.')
    for i in range(1,my_number_of_channels+1): #from 1 to 4 inclusive if TP1xx4
        print('        delay in channel',i,end='\t')
        print(my_device.getDelay(i),end='')
        print('ps')

    #Get last calibration time
    print(f"\nLast delay calibration via my_device.getLastDelaySync(): {my_device.
↪getLastDelaySync()}")
    print(f"Last delay calibration (formatted): {my_device.getLastDelaySync(True)}")

    my_device.close()
    if my_device.isOpen():
        print('\nconnection with my_device is open')
    else:
        print('\nconnection with my_device is close')

except Exception as e:

```

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```

print(e)

finally:
    if my_device.isOpen():
        my_device.close() #close a connection, if it is still open

```

2.4 Advanced examples

Examples specific for Tausand Tempico advanced features.

2.4.1 fcsExample.py

```

# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""fcsExample

    Created on Thu May 14 8:23 2026

    Acquires photon arrival times from a Tausand Tempico TDC device and
    computes the normalized autocorrelation function  $G(\tau)$  in real time
    using the multi-tau algorithm. Results are displayed in a live plot
    using PySide2 and pyqtgraph.

    The acquisition loop collects stop-time measurements from the Tempico
    device, reconstructs a continuous relative timeline (ignoring inter-run
    gaps), bins the photon arrivals into intensity bins of duration TAU_0,
    and feeds each bin into a MultiTauCorrelator instance. The resulting
     $G(\tau)$  curve is emitted to the GUI after every batch of runs.

    Instructions:
        - Make sure pyTempico and MultipleTauCorrelator are installed
          or available in the Python path.
        - Replace MY_PORT with the serial port of your Tempico device
          (e.g. COM4 on Windows or /dev/ttyUSB0 on Linux).
        - Connect a periodic signal to the start input and the photon
          detector output to the stop input of Channel 1.
        - Adjust TAU_0, NUMBER_OF_STOPS, NUMBER_OF_RUNS, and
          TOTAL_SECONDS as needed for your experiment.
        - Run the script. The live  $G(\tau)$  plot will appear immediately and
          update every batch of 100 runs until the acquisition finishes or
          the window is closed.

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    | https://www.tausand.com
"""

import sys
import os

```

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```

# Add the parent directory to the Python path so that MultipleTauCorrelator
# can be imported even when this script is run from a subdirectory
sys.path.append(os.path.abspath(os.path.join(os.path.dirname(__file__), '..')))

import time
import pyTempico
from multipleTauCorrelator import MultiTauCorrelator
import numpy as np
from PySide2.QtWidgets import QApplication, QMainWindow, QWidget, QVBoxLayout, QLabel
from PySide2.QtCore import QThread, Signal, QTimer
import pyqtgraph as pg

# — Configuration —————
MY_PORT      = 'COM4'      # Serial port of the Tempico device
NUMBER_OF_STOPS = 2        # Stop events per run (1-5)
NUMBER_OF_RUNS  = 100      # Runs per measure() call (1-1000)
TOTAL_SECONDS   = 120      # Total acquisition duration in seconds
TAU_0           = 1_000_000 # Base bin size in picoseconds (1 μs)
PLOT_UPDATE_MS  = 500      # GUI refresh interval in milliseconds
# —————

# — Worker thread: acquisition + correlation —————
class AcquisitionWorker(QThread):
    """
    Background thread that handles Tempico communication and multi-tau
    correlation. Runs independently of the GUI thread to keep the plot
    responsive during acquisition.

    Signals
    -----
    data_ready : Signal(object, object)
        Emitted after each measure() call with updated (taus_s, g) arrays.
    status_update : Signal(str)
        Emitted after each measure() call with a human-readable status string.
    finished_sig : Signal()
        Emitted once when the acquisition loop exits normally.
    """

    # Emits (taus_s, g) arrays after every batch of runs
    data_ready = Signal(object, object)
    # Emits a status string for display in the GUI label
    status_update = Signal(str)
    # Emitted once when the acquisition loop finishes
    finished_sig = Signal()

    def __init__(self, port, number_of_stops, number_of_runs,
                 total_seconds, tau_0_ps):
        super().__init__()
        self.port = port
        self.number_of_stops = number_of_stops
        self.number_of_runs = number_of_runs

```

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```

self.total_seconds = total_seconds
self.tau_0_ps = tau_0_ps
# Flag used by stop() to request a clean exit from the run() loop
self._running = True

def stop(self):
    """Request the acquisition loop to exit on the next iteration."""
    self._running = False

def run(self):
    """
    Main acquisition and correlation loop. Runs in a separate thread.

    Connects to the Tempico device, configures Channel 1, then enters
    a loop that calls measure() repeatedly until the elapsed time exceeds
    ``total_seconds`` or ``stop()`` is called. Each batch of rows is
    processed into intensity bins and fed into the correlator. The
    updated G(tau) curve is emitted after every batch.
    """
    # --- Device connection and configuration ---
    device = pyTempico.TempicoDevice(self.port)
    device.open()
    if not device.isOpen():
        self.status_update.emit(f"ERROR: Could not open port {self.port}")
        return

    self.status_update.emit(f"Connected to {device.getIdn()}")
    # Reset clears all previous measurements and restores default settings
    device.reset()

    # Enable only Channel 1; disable the rest to avoid unwanted triggers
    device.ch1.enableChannel()
    device.ch2.disableChannel()
    device.ch3.disableChannel()
    device.ch4.disableChannel()
    # Mode 2: large measurement range (125 ns - 4 ms start-stop window)
    device.ch1.setMode(2)
    device.ch1.setNumberOfStops(self.number_of_stops)
    device.setNumberOfRuns(self.number_of_runs)

    # Instantiate the multi-tau correlator with the configured bin size
    correlator = MultiTauCorrelator(tau_0=self.tau_0_ps,
                                    num_levels=16, m=16)

    # cursor_ps: running position on the relative timeline (ps).
    # Advances by the last stop time of each run, ignoring inter-run gaps.
    cursor_ps = 0
    # next_bin_edge: upper boundary of the current intensity bin (ps).
    # When an event crosses this boundary, the bin is closed and a new
    # one starts.
    next_bin_edge = self.tau_0_ps
    # photons_in_bin: photon counter for the current open bin

```

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```

photons_in_bin = 0

t_start      = time.time()    # Wall-clock time at acquisition start
call_count   = 0              # Number of measure() calls completed
total_events = 0              # Total photon events collected so far

# --- Main acquisition loop ---
while self._running and (time.time() - t_start) < self.total_seconds:
    # Request one batch of (NUMBER_OF_RUNS × NUMBER_OF_STOPS) measurements
    # Each row has format: [ch, run, start_s, stop_ps1, ..., stop_psN]
    data = device.measure()

    for row in data:
        # Extract stop times in picoseconds (columns 3 onwards)
        stops_ps = row[3:]

        for t_ps in stops_ps:
            # Compute the absolute position of this event on the
            # relative timeline by adding the run's cursor offset
            abs_t = cursor_ps + t_ps

            # Close all bins that end before this event arrives.
            # Bins with zero photons (empty bins) are also fed to the
            # correlator - they carry statistical information about
            # periods of silence.
            while abs_t >= next_bin_edge:
                correlator.process_datum(photons_in_bin)
                photons_in_bin = 0
                next_bin_edge += self.tau_0_ps

            # Register this photon in the current open bin
            photons_in_bin += 1
            total_events  += 1

        # Advance the timeline cursor to the last stop of this run.
        # The gap between the last stop and the next run's first stop
        # is intentionally ignored (Option B: relative timeline).
        cursor_ps += stops_ps[-1]

    call_count += 1
    elapsed = time.time() - t_start

    # Retrieve the current ACF and emit it to the GUI for plotting
    taus, g = correlator.get_correlation_curve()
    if len(taus) > 0:
        # Convert lag times from picoseconds to seconds before emitting
        self.data_ready.emit(taus * 1e-12, g)

    self.status_update.emit(
        f"calls: {call_count} | events: {total_events} | "
        f"elapsed: {elapsed:.1f} s"
    )

```

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```

    # Flush the last partially filled bin into the correlator
    correlator.process_datum(photons_in_bin)
    taus, g = correlator.get_correlation_curve()
    if len(taus) > 0:
        self.data_ready.emit(taus * 1e-12, g)

    device.close()
    self.status_update.emit("Acquisition finished.")
    self.finished_sig.emit()

# — Main window —————
class MainWindow(QMainWindow):
    """
    Main application window. Contains a status label and a pyqtgraph
    PlotWidget that displays the live G(tau) autocorrelation curve.
    Starts the AcquisitionWorker thread on construction and stops it
    cleanly when the window is closed.
    """

    def __init__(self):
        super().__init__()
        self.setWindowTitle("FCS - Real-time Autocorrelation")
        self.resize(900, 550)

        # Central widget and vertical layout
        central = QWidget()
        self.setCentralWidget(central)
        layout = QVBoxLayout(central)

        # Status label: shows acquisition progress from the worker thread
        self.status_label = QLabel("Starting acquisition...")
        self.status_label.setStyleSheet("font-size: 11px; color: #444;")
        layout.addWidget(self.status_label)

        # --- pyqtgraph plot widget ---
        self.plot_widget = pg.PlotWidget()
        self.plot_widget.setBackground('w')
        self.plot_widget.setLabel('left', 'G( $\tau$ )')
        self.plot_widget.setLabel('bottom', ' $\tau$ ', units='s')
        self.plot_widget.setTitle('Autocorrelation Function - Tempico FCS')
        # Logarithmic x-axis: standard presentation for FCS curves
        self.plot_widget.setLogMode(x=True, y=False)
        self.plot_widget.showGrid(x=True, y=True, alpha=0.3)
        self.plot_widget.addLegend()

        # Horizontal dashed reference line at G = 1 (uncorrelated baseline)
        ref_line = pg.InfiniteLine(
            pos=1.0, angle=0,
            pen=pg.mkPen('gray', width=1, style=pg.QtCore.Qt.DashLine)
        )

```

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```

self.plot_widget.addItem(ref_line)

# Scatter plot curve: updated in real time by update_plot()
self.curve = self.plot_widget.plot(
    [], [],
    pen=None,
    symbol='o',
    symbolSize=5,
    symbolBrush='steelblue',
    symbolPen=None,
    name='G( $\tau$ ) measured'
)

layout.addWidget(self.plot_widget)

# --- Acquisition worker ---
# Runs in a separate QThread to avoid blocking the GUI event loop
self.worker = AcquisitionWorker(
    port          = MY_PORT,
    number_of_stops = NUMBER_OF_STOPS,
    number_of_runs  = NUMBER_OF_RUNS,
    total_seconds   = TOTAL_SECONDS,
    tau_0_ps        = TAU_0,
)

# Connect worker signals to GUI slots
self.worker.data_ready.connect(self.update_plot)
self.worker.status_update.connect(self.update_status)
self.worker.finished_sig.connect(self.on_finished)
self.worker.start()

def update_plot(self, taus_s, g):
    """Update the scatter plot with the latest G(tau) values."""
    # pyqtgraph requires strictly positive x values when logMode x=True
    mask = taus_s > 0
    self.curve.setData(taus_s[mask], g[mask])

def update_status(self, msg):
    """Update the status label with the latest acquisition progress."""
    self.status_label.setText(msg)

def on_finished(self):
    """Append a completion marker to the status label."""
    self.status_label.setText(
        self.status_label.text() + "  ✓ Done."
    )

def closeEvent(self, event):
    """Stop the worker thread cleanly before closing the window."""
    # Signal the worker loop to exit, then wait for the thread to finish
    self.worker.stop()
    self.worker.wait()
    event.accept()

```

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```
# — Entry point —————
def main():
    app = QApplication(sys.argv)
    # Enable antialiasing for smoother scatter plot markers
    pg.setConfigOptions(antialias=True)
    window = MainWindow()
    window.show()
    sys.exit(app.exec_())

if __name__ == '__main__':
    main()
```

2.4.2 multipleTauCorrelator.py

```
# -*- coding: utf-8 -*-
"""MultipleTauCorrelator

Created on Thu May 14 8:23 2026

Subroutine of fcsExample.py

Multi-tau autocorrelation algorithm for Fluorescence Correlation
Spectroscopy (FCS). Computes the normalized autocorrelation function
G(tau) from a stream of intensity values (photon counts per bin) using
the multi-tau scheme, which combines linear spacing at short lag times
with logarithmic spacing at long lag times.

Instructions:
- Import this module and instantiate ``MultiTauCorrelator`` with
  the desired ``tau_0``, ``num_levels``, and ``m`` parameters.
- Feed intensity bins one at a time using ``process_datum(value)``,
  where ``value`` is the photon count in each time bin.
- After feeding all data, call ``get_correlation_curve()`` to
  retrieve the arrays of lag times and G(tau) values.
- The lag times are returned in the same units as ``tau_0``.
  If ``tau_0`` is given in picoseconds, divide by 1e12 to convert
  to seconds.

Example usage::

    correlator = MultiTauCorrelator(tau_0=100e3, num_levels=16, m=16)
    for photon_count in intensity_series:
        correlator.process_datum(photon_count)
    taus, g = correlator.get_correlation_curve()

/ @author: Miguelangel García Castillo, Tausand Electronics
/ mgarcia@tausand.com
```

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```

| https://www.tausand.com
"""

import numpy as np

# --- MULTI-TAU CORRELATOR CLASS ---
class MultiTauCorrelator:
    """
    Multi-tau autocorrelation algorithm for Fluorescence Correlation Spectroscopy (FCS).

    Computes the normalized autocorrelation function  $G(\tau)$  from a stream of
    intensity values (photon counts per bin) using the multi-tau scheme.
    This scheme uses linearly spaced channels at the base level and
    logarithmically spaced channels at higher levels, allowing efficient
    computation over many decades of lag time.

    The normalization used is:

        
$$G(\tau) = \langle I(t) * I(t + \tau) \rangle / \langle I(t) \rangle^2$$


    where  $I(t)$  is the photon count in bin  $t$ .

    Parameters
    -----
    tau_0 : float, optional
        Base lag time (duration of the smallest bin), in any consistent time
        unit (e.g. picoseconds). Default is 1.0.
    num_levels : int, optional
        Number of levels in the multi-tau hierarchy. Each level  $k$  covers lag
        times up to  $m * 2^k * \tau_0$ . Default is 16.
    m : int, optional
        Number of channels (shift register length) per level. Must be a
        positive even integer. The first level uses all  $m$  channels with
        linear spacing. Higher levels use the upper  $m/2$  channels to avoid
        overlap with the previous level. Default is 16.

    Attributes
    -----
    shift_registers : list of numpy.ndarray
        Circular buffers of length  $m$  for each level, holding the  $m$  most
        recent binned intensity values at that level's time resolution.
    A : list of numpy.ndarray
        Accumulated cross-products for each channel at each level.
        Used as the numerator of  $G(\tau)$ .
    M_del : list of numpy.ndarray
        Accumulated sum of delayed (older) intensity values for each channel
        at each level. Used as part of the denominator of  $G(\tau)$ .
    M_dir : numpy.ndarray
        Accumulated sum of direct (current) intensity values for each level.
        Used as part of the denominator of  $G(\tau)$ .
    n_bins : numpy.ndarray of int
        Number of bins processed at each level.

```

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```

z_buffer : numpy.ndarray
    Accumulation buffer used to combine pairs of bins when passing data
    from level k to level k+1.

Examples
-----
>>> correlator = MultiTauCorrelator(tau_0=100e3, num_levels=16, m=16)
>>> for photon_count in intensity_series:
...     correlator.process_datum(photon_count)
>>> taus, g = correlator.get_correlation_curve()
"""
def __init__(self, tau_0=1.0, num_levels=16, m=16):
    # Store the base lag time; all tau values will be multiples of this
    self.tau_0 = tau_0
    # Total number of levels in the multi-tau hierarchy
    self.num_levels = num_levels
    # Number of channels (shift register slots) per level
    self.m = m

    # One shift register per level: holds the m most recent intensity
    # values at that level's time resolution. Acts as a circular buffer.
    self.shift_registers = [np.zeros(m) for _ in range(num_levels)]

    # A[k][i]: accumulated cross-product between current bin and the bin
    # that arrived i+1 steps ago at level k. Numerator of G(tau).
    self.A = [np.zeros(m) for _ in range(num_levels)]

    # M_del[k][i]: accumulated sum of delayed intensity values at channel i,
    # level k. Tracks the mean of the older (delayed) signal. Part of denominator.
    self.M_del = [np.zeros(m) for _ in range(num_levels)]

    # M_dir[k]: accumulated sum of direct (current) intensity at level k.
    # Tracks the mean of the newer (direct) signal. Part of denominator.
    self.M_dir = np.zeros(num_levels)

    # n_bins[k]: total number of bins processed at level k.
    # Used for normalization and to determine when a level has enough data.
    self.n_bins = np.zeros(num_levels, dtype=int)

    # z_buffer[k]: temporary accumulator that sums pairs of bins from
    # level k-1 before passing them up to level k. Implements the
    # factor-of-2 coarsening between levels.
    self.z_buffer = np.zeros(num_levels)

def process_datum(self, value):
    """
    Feed a single intensity bin into the correlator.

    This method triggers the recursive multi-tau update starting at
    level 0. Each call corresponds to one time bin of duration ``tau_0``.

    Parameters

```

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```

-----
value : float
    Photon count (or intensity) for the current bin. Must be
    non-negative.

Notes
-----
Every two calls to this method at level k cause one new value to be
passed to level k+1 (with the two values summed), implementing the
factor-of-2 coarsening between levels.
"""
# Entry point: always start the recursive update at level 0
self._run_level(0, value)

def _run_level(self, k, z_k):
    """
    Perform the multi-tau update at level k with input value z_k.

    Updates the accumulator arrays A, M_del, and M_dir for level k,
    advances the shift register, and recursively propagates a coarsened
    value to level k+1 every two bins.

    Parameters
    -----
    k : int
        Current level index (0-based). Level 0 operates at the base
        time resolution ``tau_0``; level k operates at resolution
        ``2^k * tau_0``.
    z_k : float
        Intensity value (photon count) for the current bin at level k.

    Notes
    -----
    The update equations at each level are:

        A[k][i]      += z_k * shift_registers[k][i]    for all i
        M_del[k][i] += shift_registers[k][i]           for all i
        M_dir[k]     += z_k

    After updating, the shift register is rolled by one position and
    z_k is inserted at index 0 (most recent position).

    Every second call (when n_bins[k] is even), the accumulated
    z_buffer[k+1] is passed to _run_level(k+1) and reset to zero.
    """
    # Cross-product accumulation: multiply current bin z_k by each of the
    # m delayed values in the shift register. This is the core FCS
    # correlation operation: <I(t) * I(t + tau)> for all m lag channels.
    self.A[k] += z_k * self.shift_registers[k]

    # Accumulate the delayed values for normalization (denominator term).
    # M_del[k][i] will hold the sum of all values that have passed through

```

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```

# channel i, representing <I(t + tau)> for each lag.
self.M_del[k] += self.shift_registers[k]

# Accumulate the direct (current) value for normalization.
# M_dir[k] will hold the total sum of all input values at this level,
# representing <I(t)>.
self.M_dir[k] += z_k

# Count how many bins have been processed at this level
self.n_bins[k] += 1

# Advance the circular shift register: roll all values one position
# to the right (older), then insert z_k at position 0 (most recent).
# After this, shift_registers[k][i] holds the value from i+1 bins ago.
self.shift_registers[k] = np.roll(self.shift_registers[k], 1)
self.shift_registers[k][0] = z_k

# Coarsening step: accumulate z_k into the buffer for the next level.
# When two consecutive bins have been accumulated (n_bins[k] is even),
# their sum is passed up to level k+1 as a single coarser bin.
# This implements the factor-of-2 time resolution reduction per level.
if k + 1 < self.num_levels:
    self.z_buffer[k+1] += z_k
    if self.n_bins[k] % 2 == 0:
        # Two bins accumulated: send their sum to the next level
        new_z = self.z_buffer[k+1]
        # Reset buffer for the next pair
        self.z_buffer[k+1] = 0
        # Recursive call: process the coarsened bin at level k+1
        self._run_level(k + 1, new_z)

def get_correlation_curve(self):
    """
    Compute and return the normalized autocorrelation function G(tau).

    Iterates over all levels and channels, skipping levels with
    insufficient data (fewer than m bins processed) and channels
    with zero delayed accumulator (to avoid division by zero).

    At level 0, all m channels are included (linear spacing).
    At levels 1 and above, only the upper m//2 channels are included
    (indices m//2 to m-1) to avoid overlap with the previous level,
    following the standard multi-tau scheme.

    The lag time for channel i at level k is:

        tau = (i + 1) * 2^k * tau_0

    The normalized correlation value is:

        G(tau) = (A[k][i] * n_bins[k]) / (M_dir[k] * M_del[k][i])

```

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Returns

```
taus : numpy.ndarray
    Array of lag times in the same units as ``tau_0``.
g_vals : numpy.ndarray
    Array of normalized autocorrelation values  $G(\tau)$  corresponding
    to each lag time in ``taus``.
```

Notes

If fewer than ``m`` bins have been processed at a given level, that level is skipped and contributes no points to the output. This typically affects the highest levels early in an acquisition.

```
taus, g_vals = [], []
```

```
for k in range(self.num_levels):
    # Skip levels that have not yet accumulated enough bins to fill
    # all m channels of the shift register. Without this guard,
    # the early channels would be computed from incomplete data.
    if self.n_bins[k] < self.m:
        continue

    # At level 0 use all m channels (linear spacing from tau_0 to m*tau_0).
    # At levels k >= 1 skip the first m//2 channels because those lag
    # times are already covered by the previous level at finer resolution,
    # avoiding duplicate points in the output curve.
    start_idx = 0 if k == 0 else 8

    for i in range(start_idx, self.m):
        m_del = self.M_del[k][i]

        # Skip channels where no delayed data has been accumulated yet,
        # which would cause a division by zero in the normalization.
        if m_del == 0:
            continue

        # Normalized autocorrelation for channel i at level k:
        #  $G(\tau) = \langle I(t)I(t+\tau) \rangle / (\langle I(t) \rangle * \langle I(t+\tau) \rangle)$ 
        # In accumulated form:
        # numerator = A[k][i] (cross-product sum)
        # denominator = M_dir[k] / n_bins[k] * M_del[k][i] / n_bins[k]
        # Rearranging to avoid two divisions:
        #  $G = (A[k][i] * n\_bins[k]) / (M\_dir[k] * M\_del[k][i])$ 
        g = (self.A[k][i] * self.n_bins[k]) / (self.M_dir[k] * m_del)

        # Lag time for channel i at level k:
        # channel i corresponds to a delay of (i+1) bins at this level,
        # and each bin at level k has duration  $2^k * \tau_0$ .
        tau = (i + 1) * (2**k) * self.tau_0

        taus.append(tau)
```

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```
g_vals.append(g)

return np.array(taus), np.array(g_vals)
```


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